



RIBA PART 3  
EXAMINATION IN PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE

## **Autumn 2023 Scenario**

**Issued in advance of the  
Practice Problems Examination**

## **GUIDANCE NOTES**

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Candidates are to imagine themselves as an employee of the architectural practice described in the scenario, taking the role of the Candidate, responding to each of the problems set out for each of the two days, using the information given in the scenario and in the particular problems. Where a situation in a question takes place in the future, candidates should base their answers on legislative requirements in place at the time of the examination. Candidates should be aware of new and recently updated legislation but will not be expected to have a comprehensive understanding where this has been introduced immediately prior to the examination. All the questions carry equal weight and each of them must be attempted. The questions are issued at 09:00 to the candidates each day.

Some of the questions may require more investigation than others and the responses to the problems may vary in length and complexity depending on the nature and circumstances involved. It is suggested that the Candidates read all the questions before allocating an appropriate amount of time to each of the problems and allow sufficient time to read their responses before emailing them to their Examination Supervisor at 17:30 each day. The candidate should also upload a copy to the BOX.com links (provided via email on 30 August 2023) on each of the respective days.

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**17:30 Wednesday 06 September 2023 – Day One Practice problem responses**

**17:30 Thursday 07 September 2023 – Day Two Practice problem responses**

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The third day, **Friday 08 September 2023**, is solely for proof reading and typographical correction, collation and binding of one printed copy of the documentary submission which must be dispatched together with the Declaration certifying that the whole submission is the candidate's own unaided work.

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The parcel containing these documents must be securely packed and carefully addressed to Alison Mackinder, Professional Education Programmes Director, RIBA Part 3, RIBA North, 21 Mann Island, Liverpool Waterfront, **L3 1BP**.

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**Final Submission: 17:30 on Friday 08 September 2023**

## SCENARIO

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Established in 1998, the practice has a wide range of design and development experience across a number of private-sector and public-sector areas, including commercial, retail, industrial, education and health care.

Exclusively based in the north-west of England, the practice office is in a converted mill building in Central Madchester.

As a candidate for the Autumn 2023 examination, you are required to assume that you are a salaried employee of NDG Architects and have been engaged at this practice for a period of 20 months whilst preparing to sit the Part 3 examination.

Companies House records now show that NDG Architects Ltd has three directors and one associate director.

**Belinda Carter** is an architect and the Managing Director.

**Michael Hart** is a conservation architect and Director. He is a RIBA specialist conservation architect. Michael is also listed as a Client Design Advisor on the RIBA's CDA register.

**Sue Allen** is an architect and Director. She is an accredited sustainability expert and has completed a MSc course in Advanced Sustainability at the University of Madchester.

**Sven Berg** is an architect and Associate Director. He is an accredited Principal Designer, having recently completed the RIBA Principal Designer course.

### Practice Update

The rising **cost of materials, consultant fees, staff, utilities, and transport** have all put pressure on the costs of running the practice. The practice has also experienced an increase in staff turnover and has found it more difficult in recent years to attract skilled and experienced architects.

The practice has found the complexity of regulations has increased workload, with the UK government introducing a number of new regulations and updates. **NDG Architects are also increasingly aware of the need to be more sustainable and produce designs that address the climate crisis.**

Current practice members, roles, salaries and charge out rates are indicated in the table below:

| Staff and salaries/director remuneration |                                 |                    |                 |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------|
| Charge-out Hourly Rates                  |                                 |                    |                 |
| Name                                     | Role/Status                     | Salary             | Charge-out Rate |
|                                          |                                 |                    |                 |
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**Two selected significant projects currently being handled by the practice are as follows:**

### **Madchester Primary School**

The headteacher of a local school has approached NDG and asked them to assist with the design and project management of their new extension. She has stated a budget of £2m which cannot be exceeded. The existing buildings are Listed and are in a residential area overlooked by houses, some abutting the school. Currently, the school currently has 7 classrooms and the brief is to provide 3 additional classrooms and increase the size of the assembly hall.

Key stakeholders include six members of the governing body, three members of the school's senior management team, the school site manager and the canteen manager. The head teacher says that it is important that the job is completed in 16 months' time, to accommodate children arriving from another school which is closing.

It is proposed that the project is to be traditionally procured and all design, survey and cost consultant disciplines are to be sub-consultants to NDG. The head teacher points out the sensitivity of working in a live school environment.

### **Prospect Street Tower**

The practice developed a 125 unit, 21-storey residential scheme, with retail at ground floor, that was awarded Planning Approval following a Madchester Council committee in July 2020. The then client, Heyday Property, has since sold the site to a Joint Venture consisting of Row-P Developments, Sassy Hotel Group & Sky-High Real Estate. The Joint Venture, 'Prospect Street Ltd' has approached the practice with a view to bring the project forward. They are keen to start immediately – and are willing to work with the approved scheme if possible - but they want some changes to make the project 'viable'. These include the removal of the basement, an additional retail unit, co-working office facilities and a number of serviced apartments.

The site is identified in the Neighbourhood Development Framework as a prominent gateway site on the edge of Madchester city centre. The existing site contains a three-storey brick warehouse building that directly abuts several properties. Prospect Street Ltd has a budget of £40m but are keen to reduce costs where possible. They have indicated that they want to start on site quickly. The Development Director from Row-P has stated that their contractor arm, 'Row-P Build' could possibly act as main contractor. They would like to start demolition work in May 2024, with a provisional construction programme lasting 2 years.

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## **Autumn 2023 Practice Problems**

### **Day 1**

### **Questions 1-5**

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**END**



## QUESTION 1

Page 1 of 1

*Belinda.Carter@ndgarchitects.co.uk*

*EMAIL*

**Date** 06 September 2023  
**To:** Candidate  
**From:** Belinda Carter  
**Re:** **Madchester Primary School – Opposition**

---

Good morning Candidate,

Having started work on the primary school extension and agreed the programme of 16 months, it has become increasingly apparent that there is significant opposition to the proposal.

The opposition is largely related to parents' concerns about a decrease in teaching standards and have cited the following:

- The extension is to accommodate additional children from a school which is closing due to falling standards and poor student behaviour.
- Parents and the local community also have concerns about transport as there is a limited public transport between the two schools and parking problems and congestion in the roads around the school are significant – there is nothing in the brief to extend the parking/drop-off area for school children.

Many parents and locals have joined together to oppose the plans and this is likely to have a significant effect on the planning process and the very tight programme.

We are concerned that to meet the timeframe and budget it is imperative that these issues are addressed straight away. You are to arrange a meeting with the headmistress and other stakeholders to discuss a strategy to address and mitigate the effect of this opposition.

Please prepare an agenda and notes for discussion at the meeting which outlines:

- The risks to the project and ways in which to mitigate these.
- A strategy and actions to address the local opposition to the project.
- Who do you think would be best to chair this meeting and why.

Many thanks and best regards,

Belinda Carter

*Director, NDG Architects*

## QUESTION 2

Page 1 of 1

*Belinda.Carter@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

**Date** 13 September 2023  
**To:** Candidate  
**From:** Belinda Carter  
**Re:** **Madchester Primary School – Can we afford this?**

---

Hi Candidate,

Ms Lion, the headteacher from Madchester Primary School approached and asked NDG to look at a 3-classroom extension with some modifications to the assembly hall. We undertook a limited feasibility study.

The delivery of the project is being funded and managed by the local authority on a traditional basis with NDG as architect, lead consultant and contract administrator.

Fortunately, we were accepted onto the LA framework a couple of years ago where we stated we could deliver a traditionally procured project of this type and value for an overall fee of 12% including all necessary professional consultants acting as sub consultants to NDG.

However, having now obtained fee quotations from the various consultants I am wondering if it is worth it?

Can we deliver the project for the fee? What are the risks? Please produce a comprehensive report for the NDG partners based on your assessment of the resources needed to deliver the project within the 16 months, including a recommendation to take the job on or to withdraw. Please also include potential actions that you recommend for consideration.

Fee quotations:

- a. Engineer @ 2%
- b. Cost consultant @ 1.5%
- c. MEP engineer @ 3%
- d. Principal designer @ 0.5%

This leaves NDG Architect's fee @ 5% of £2m

Belinda Carter

*Director, NDG Architects*

### QUESTION 3

Page 1 of 3

*Dareem.Patel@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

Date: 16 May 2024  
To: Candidate  
From: Dareem Patel  
Re: **Madchester Primary School – Planning Update**

---

Hi Candidate,

I wanted to update you on Manchester Primary School following a call with the Planning officer at Madchester Council.

The planning application for the school extension was submitted to the council over 26 weeks ago and has taken longer than expected.

The 'pre-app' process identified the reports which should be submitted with the planning application, and these have all been produced and submitted with the application. We could have submitted fewer reports, but we want to avoid any pre-start planning conditions so we can start work on site as soon as the application is approved.

We are working to a very tight programme and had to issue tender documents to Contractors to meet the Client's completion date. We hope to receive 4 tender prices in two weeks' time and start work on site soon after.

The Planning Officer indicated they expect the decision notice to be published shortly. I'll follow up once this arrives.

Kind regards,

Dareem Patel

*Senior Architect, NDG Architects*

### QUESTION 3

Page 2 of 3

*Dareem.Patel@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

Date: 21 May 2024

To: Candidate

From: Dareem Patel

**Re: Madchester Primary School – Condition Concerns**

---

Hi again Candidate,

The planning officer has now sent me a copy of the decision notice and I am genuinely concerned to see 25 conditions which I was not expecting particularly as we have submitted a detailed and complete planning application.

I am away from the office tomorrow, but could you please read the conditions listed below which I feel could cause us problems.

#### *Condition 12*

*Prior to the commencement of any construction work, a detailed 'construction methodology' should be submitted and approved in writing by the council. This should include a contractor's compound layout indicating a temporary welfare building, material storage car parking, wheel wash and signage. It should also include daily vehicle movements and management strategy for large vehicles visiting the site.*

#### *Condition 15*

*Prior to the commencement of any construction work, revised floor plans should be submitted and approved in writing by the council to indicate how wheelchair users can access every part of the new extension from the existing building.*

#### *Condition 17*

*Prior to occupation of any part of the building, proposals should be submitted to and approved in writing by the council to indicate a 'hedgehog superhighway' across the site with boundary access points where hedgehogs can move freely between adjacent sites.*

#### *Condition 21*

*Prior to occupation of any part of the site or building, the agreed remediation strategy shall be implemented, and a validation/ completion report produced documenting any ground contamination found during construction work, testing and certificates for imported ground materials and submitted to the council and approved in writing by the council.*

**QUESTION 3**  
**Page 3 of 3**

*CONTINUED...*

*EMAIL*

---

Date: 21 May 2024  
To: Candidate  
From: Dareem Patel  
**Re: Madchester Primary School – Condition Concerns**

---

Can you please let me have your views on the implication these conditions may have on the project and if there is anything we can do about them.

I look forward to receiving your reply.

Yours faithfully

Dareem Patel  
*Senior Architect, NDG Architects*

## QUESTION 4

Page 1 of 1

*NDG Architects*

*INTERNAL MEMO*

Date: 22 May 2024  
To: Candidate  
From: Michael Hart  
Re: **Advice on Dismissing an Employee**

---

Hi Candidate,

I received a call from a good friend of mine. She used to work for us five or so years ago and eventually set up on her own and has a small successful practice of 6 employees.

She is worried and has asked my advice. She employed a Part 2 architectural assistant, who at first was very attentive, had good timekeeping, and was very professional. She initially thought she chose well, but after the employee's probation period was completed and full-time employment was offered and accepted, there has been a complete change.

This started with increased gossiping then disobedience, insubordination, and disrespecting authority. She says this is harming the office and believes the disruptive behaviour is spreading amongst her staff and that it is severely affecting work output and is also impacting her personally in that she does not want to go into the office anymore.

She has spoken with the member of staff but to no avail. My friend does not see any option but to dismiss this member of staff but is unsure of the procedure and what the consequences of this will be for the office. So, as you are completing your part 3, in memo format I would be interested in your view of the situation.

How would you deal with this if it were your practice, what is the procedure that should be followed and how would you address the potential consequences for the office?

Thanks

Michael Hart  
*Director, NDG Architects*

## QUESTION 5

Page 1 of 3

*Sven.Berg@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

Date: 05 August 2024

To: Candidate

From: Sven Berg

Re: **Madchester Primary School – Project Update**

---

Dear Candidate,

A few months have passed since you have been on this project, so I had better give you a bit of an update.

Work has finally started on site 5 months later than planned due to the time taken to obtain planning approval and discharge the 'pre-start' conditions. Two of the tender prices were within the client's budget and after checking, the lowest contractor was awarded the project. They quickly produced a 'construction method statement' required by condition 12 and we provided the updated wheelchair plans required by condition 15 but it took the council 12 weeks to provide the written approval which allowed work to start.

Unfortunately, during excavations for foundations, the contractor has found an old fuel tank buried in the ground which did not appear on any survey. This has now been removed but has caused a further 4 weeks delay plus extra cost of £11k.

The client is extremely unhappy and has informed the consultants and contractor that no further delay will be acceptable. A new occupation date has been agreed which is 3 weeks after practical completion.

Best regards,

Sven Berg  
*Associate Director, NDG Architects*

**QUESTION 5**  
**Page 2 of 3**

Sven.Berg@ndgarchitects.com

EMAIL

Date: 07 August 2024  
To: Candidate  
From: Sven Berg  
Re: **Madchester Primary School – Phone Message**

---

Dear Candidate,

I have had a very disturbing telephone discussion with the contractor regarding planning condition 21 which has to be discharged before the building can be occupied.

*Condition 21*

*Prior to occupation of any part of the site or building, the agreed remediation strategy shall be implemented, and a validation/ completion report produced documenting any ground contamination found during construction work, testing and certificates for imported ground materials and submitted to the council and approved in writing by the council.*

The contractor has reminded me of their contractual obligation to obtain 'practical completion' by the agreed date otherwise they will be charged substantial financial penalties if the date is missed. There is a contractual obligation on the contractor to work to the agreed 'remediation strategy' which has planning approval but there is no contractual agreement to provide the completion reports or discharge any planning condition. The contractor has agreed to assist the client's team with the reports, testing and certification of the ground conditions but this is a 'goodwill' gesture and not a contractual obligation. The discovery and removal of the buried fuel tank will make the reports more complex and expensive and could also mean the council will take longer than expected to review them and could also raise queries.

The contractor has tried to complete the external works early in the programme but the tank has delayed this work so it will be at the end, which means the reports may not be ready at practical completion. This means that we could have a complete building that cannot be occupied until the condition is discharged, which could take several months.



**QUESTION 5**  
**Page 3 of 3**

*CONTINUED...*

*EMAIL*

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Date: 07 August 2024  
To: Candidate  
From: Sven Berg  
Re: **Madchester Primary School – Phone Message**

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Can you please have a review of this and let me have your thoughts on the following points.

1. Is the contractor's statement correct? I am concerned we will have a completed building which cannot be occupied.
2. Is there anything which can be done to minimise the delay to occupying the building?
3. Is there anything we could have done differently to avoid this situation?

I look forward to receiving your reply.

Yours faithfully

Sven Berg  
*Associate Director, NDG Architects*

**END OF DAY ONE**

**Please ensure that you email a copy of your draft answers  
to your exam supervisor  
at 17:30**

**&**

**Please ensure that you upload a copy of your draft answers  
to the box.com link (provided in the exam scenario email sent 30 August 2023)  
at 17:30**



RIBA PART 3  
EXAMINATION IN PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE

## **Autumn 2023 Practice Problems**

### **Day 2**

### **Questions 6-10**

## QUESTION 6

Page 1 of 2

*Tomas.Hjeltnes@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

---

Date: 06 September 2023  
To: Candidate  
From: Tomas Hjeltnes  
Re: **Prospect Street Tower – Environmental Concerns**

---

Hi Candidate,

Please can you look at the attached article? (overleaf)

Do you think we need to take any of these concerns seriously?

I would value your opinion. Does it raise concerns that we ought to address?

This project is important for the practice, so I want us to anticipate any potential issues.

We are going to be meeting with representatives from Prospect Street Limited on Friday. They are not aware of this publicity and do not seem overly familiar with environmental concerns. From initial discussions, it is clear they want to demolish the existing buildings and work with the consented scheme. However, they want some changes to make the project 'viable,' including the removal of the basement, an additional retail unit, co-working office facilities, and a few additional apartments.

I would appreciate it if you could draft a memorandum that summarises the sustainable and ethical concerns. Feel free to expand on the issues in the article and supplement these with any concerns of your own.

Considering we are at an early stage; I would also appreciate your thoughts regarding the ways we could address these concerns going forward.

Kind regards,

**Tomas Hjeltnes**

*Senior Architect, NDG Architects*

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### Environmental Concerns as Joint Venture Buys Site

Concerns have been raised following the purchase of Prospect Street by a Joint Venture consisting of Row-P Developments, Sassy Hotel Group and Sky-High Real Estate.

The site is identified as a gateway site on Madchester Council's Neighbourhood Development Framework to revamp the area.

But concerns have been raised that the demolition of the existing buildings will result in thousands of tonnes of CO<sub>2</sub> being released into the atmosphere. Campaigners also argue that the existing building is made from high-quality durable materials, and contains examples of sustainable construction, including locally sourced bricks and heavy-timber flooring.

Opposition has grown following news of the purchase by the Joint Venture, Prospect Street Limited. Row-P were fined by the Environment Agency last year after failing to meet environmental standards on several previous Schemes. Sassy Hotel Group



Prospect Street Ltd. Has purchased the former warehouse site | Photograph: Unsplash

has been criticized for its high levels of energy consumption and water waste, and is considered one of the most polluting hotel companies. And Sky-High Real Estate have been fined by the Financial Conduct Authority for charging excessive fees to tenants. Their involvement has stoked fears that environmental concerns will be overlooked.

Heyday Properties achieved Planning Approval for the demolition of the existing buildings and replacement with a Residential-led scheme designed by NDG Architects in July 2020, but failed to take the project forward.



## QUESTION 7

Page 1 of 1

*Sue.Allen@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

Date: 06 October 2023

To: Candidate

From: Sue Allen

Re: **Prospect Street Tower – Procurement Clarity**

---

Hi Candidate,

At our last Design Team Meeting, The Client, Prospect Street Ltd. stated that following planning, they are keen to move forward using a Design and Build route. The cost consultant will act as Employer's Agent and everyone else will be novated to the D+B contractor. The MEP (Mechanical, Electrical & Plumbing) Engineer was not keen on the prospect. So far, NDG has only been commissioned to obtain planning approval and is producing information up to RIBA Stage 3. Bearing in mind how quickly Prospect Street Ltd wants to get on site, with the prospective situation on procurement now clearer, I would be grateful if you could provide me with a memo to clarify the following:

1. If the project is sent out for single stage D+B tender, who do you recommend will be responsible for producing the tender pack, assessing the tender returns and contractors' proposals?
2. What will the tender pack consist of, what are 'Employers Requirements' and what part will NDG play, if any?
3. Based on your response to questions 1+2 above, should NDG charge a fee, and if so, on what basis should it be calculated? (I do not need actual figures here)
4. At what point will NDG be novated to the contractor, what will their role be, how should their fee be calculated and with whom do they negotiate the fee? (again, I do not need actual figure)
5. In view of Prospect Street Limited's decision to go D+B, how should we advise them regarding our ongoing role and any professional advice that they may require during the tender process and following our novation?
6. How should we deal with the MEP's reluctance to be novated to the D+B contractor?

**Sue Allen**

*Director, NDG Architects*

## QUESTION 8

Page 1 of 1

*Renata.Wang@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

Date: 10 October 2023  
To: Candidate  
From: Renata Wang  
Re: **Prospect Street Tower – Next Steps**

---

Hi Candidate,

As a practice we are familiar with the site and project at Prospect Street. However, considering the passage of time since we undertook the work for Heyday, I think we'd better re-evaluate the project against legislation that may be relevant. With you currently undertaking Part 3, I think you would be well placed to investigate this for us.

Please can you draft a short report on the next steps required to take the project forward. I need you to focus on the legislative processes and their potential effect on the programme.

1. What changes to building safety and planning legislation have taken place since the original planning consent and are they relevant to the project?
2. Taking account of the changes to the brief and with reference to the July 2020 planning consent, what actions would you recommend?
3. What additional information may be required?
4. What are the effects of the new legislation on the client's programme for the project from Work Stages 3 to 6?

Many thanks,

**Renata Wang**

*Senior Architect, NDG Architects*

## QUESTION 9

Page 1 of 1

*Micheal.Hart@ndgarchitects.com*

*EMAIL*

Date: 20 February 2024  
To: Candidate  
From: Michael Hart  
Re: **Prospect Street Tower – Cashflow**

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Hi Candidate,

I hear from Belinda that you have done splendid work on the window package for the Prospect Street Tower. Well done!!!

As you know, we were appointed by Prospect Street Ltd, which is a JV company set up specifically for this project. It is an exciting and important project for the office and a game changer, but there is concern that potentially we have created an 'Eggs in one basket' scenario and that we have dedicated a considerable amount of office resources to this project. A more concerning issue that has been raised at the last directors meeting is that we are still awaiting an invoice to be settled, it is my understanding that the payment terms set by the client are that invoices are issued monthly but payment is on a 90-day basis.

We are currently four months into the drawing programme and have not received payment yet. This is causing severe cashflow issues for the office and does raise some concerns about the client. But I do understand that the invoice will be settled in the next couple of days.

However, we do need to prepare our next course of action if the invoice is not settled. As you are completing your Part 3, I thought it was a good opportunity for you to explore the potential dire consequences for the practice.

I would like you to prepare a memorandum listing our next steps, what are short & long-term effects on the practice, and what options are available for the practice to overcome this financial situation? And finally, how can we avoid this situation in the future?

**Michael Hart**

*Director, NDG Architects*



## QUESTION 10

Page 1 of 3

*Sven.Berg@NDGArchitects.co.uk*

*EMAIL*

Date: 29 October 2024  
To: Candidate  
From: Sven Berg  
Re: **Prospect Street Tower – Issue**

---

Dear Candidate,

I received the following email from the Development Director at Row-P Developments first thing today.

I'm out this morning. The next site meeting is tomorrow afternoon (where we will be part of the Contractor's team having been novated after having prepared the Employers Requirements), which we are both going to be at, so can you investigate this for me ahead of my getting into the office this afternoon?

Put your thoughts together on how we might overcome this (try to avoid the blame game, but do let me know if you think we are at fault):

1. Start by outlining the problem: you may need to explain it, very concisely, at the meeting to those not familiar with the issue.
2. What does this mean for the project?
3. What solutions can we offer and what are the pros and cons of each?
4. What duties under CDM regulations do we need to consider?
5. And finally, "Sky High Real Estate aren't looking to apportion blame, yet": but if they do, could we have done anything differently?

**Sven Berg**

*Associate Director, NDG Architects*

## QUESTION 10

Page 2 of 3

*FFluent@Row-P.co.uk*

*EMAIL*

Date: 29 October 2024  
To: Sven Berg  
From: Fred Fluent  
Re: **Prospect Street Tower – Blocks**

---

Dear Sven,

You will recall at the October Project Team meeting we were all looking at changes to make the scheme more viable. NDG had designed the new external masonry walls to the lower-level residential apartments to have masonry cavity wall infill panels comprising an inner leaf of “Bestlightest” aircrete block and full fill cavity insulation and a decorative facing brick masonry outer leaf. A standard build-up and one our site team are familiar with.

Our site contracts manager stated that Row-P “don’t like aircrete blocks, they crumble, and are rubbish”. They have had issues in the past with them breaking when drilled into and being too brittle for site handling, with excessive wastage. They wanted them changed to a lightweight concrete block.

The minutes of the meeting do show you had concerns that just changing one block for another might have unforeseen consequences. We all agreed to investigate it collaboratively, as it would be an improvement and a cost saving, what is not to like! You said that you had an Architectural Assistant studying for their Part 3 exam who would investigate it.

Row-Ps Quantity Surveyor spoke with “Thunderbox Ltd”: whose lightweight concrete product (Thunderbox 2000) we had used loads of times over the past few years. Thunderbox advised the QS that the Thunderbox 2000 had the same strength, density and better “overall” performance than “Bestlightest” aircrete block, and it would achieve the same U-Value and thermal performance. The QS sent the information to you and asked you to check if it was a “like-for-like” product. You responded that your keen assistant had sent it through to the Approved Inspector: who advised this change would not result in their initial comments needing further adjustment. The insulation manufacturer also advised that the insulation would not need changing and achieved the same U-Values with the varied block type.

It was agreed at the June Project Meeting that the Thunderbox 2000 blockwork would be installed in lieu of the “Bestlightest” blocks. Everyone was happy and agreed to the change.

**QUESTION 10**  
**Page 3 of 3**

*CONTINUED...*

*EMAIL*

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Date: 29 October 2024  
To: Sven Berg  
From: Fred Fluent  
**Re: Prospect Street Tower – Blocks**

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We now have a bit of an issue:

The first show apartments are approaching completion and the SAP Assessor who was brought in to prepare the “as-built” SAP calcs and EPCs has advised that they think there is an issue with the blocks, and the change of supplier. Partly due to the 2022 Part L changes (which is why it was not an issue in the previous earlier projects): the “Thunderbox 2000” lightweight concrete blocks and insulation do have the same overall wall U-Value. Unfortunately, Thunderbox Ltd do not have a manufacturer’s Psi value calculated and it looks like some of the non-repeating thermal bridges are not going to pass the calculations: because without the technical values, they default to a worse performance.

Sky High Real Estate are not looking to apportion blame yet, but I would like your thoughts on the issue and, ahead of a site meeting, to table solutions to resolve this. If you can prepare options for discussion ahead of the meeting, we might be able to avert disaster.

Fred Fluent

*Development Director, Row-P Developments*

**END OF DAY TWO**

**Please ensure that you email a copy of your draft answers  
to your exam supervisor  
at 17:30**

**&**

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